PROGRAMME SPECIFICATION · B2B COHORT GUIDE

Sponsored Executive MBA: Cohort Specification & Sponsorship Framework

A proposed employer-sponsored leadership pathway that builds your succession bench while your managers keep delivering. Academic core shared with the individual Executive MBA, plus a sponsor layer that connects development to a live organisational challenge.

AUDIENCE	CHROs, VP Talent, L&D heads, business-unit sponsors and nomination committees
FORMAT	Part-time blended; scheduled live sessions with digital support, cases, simulations and a workplace capstone
COMMERCIALS	Academic fee Rs 6,50,000 per seat plus Sponsor Success Pack Rs 40,000; volume bands from 3 seats; three-year seat-bank framework
STATUS	Student design proposal for academic evaluation; not an approved TAPMI programme and not open for enrolment

COHORT SPECIFICATION & SPONSORSHIP FRAMEWORK

OVERVIEW

1. The offer at a glance

Employers do not need to send their best people away for two years. The Sponsored Leadership Pathway develops high-potential managers inside a shared Executive MBA cohort, adds a sponsor layer around the academic core, and anchors the work in a live problem your organisation already needs solved.

ELEMENT	PROPOSED DESIGN
Programme	TAPMI Executive MBA: Sponsored Leadership Pathway (same academic core as the individual Executive MBA)
Customer	Enterprise sponsors in technology and SaaS, Bengaluru GCCs, services and industrial employers, nominating one or more high-potential managers
Academic core	Part-time blended Executive MBA; same faculty, assessment and completion standards as self-funded learners; one cohort, one standard

Sponsor layer	Nomination criteria agreed with the sponsor, protected-study-time guideline, manager briefing at the start of each term, capstone alignment, term-end progress notes
Capstone	Individual capstone on a problem chosen jointly by learner and sponsor, with confidentiality terms agreed before the project starts
Reporting	One progress note per term end; capstone review attended by a sponsor representative if the learner agrees
Commercials	One agreement and invoice route per sponsor; fee tranches by term; volume bands and a three-year seat-bank framework for repeat nominations
Governance	Admission and academic standards remain the institution's; employment and bonding terms remain between employer and employee

WHY ONE ACADEMIC FEE FOR EVERYONE

Sponsored and self-funded learners pay the same academic fee and sit in the same classroom. That protects the programme's standard, prevents arbitrage between seat types, and keeps the sponsor's premium where it belongs: on the service layer, not the degree.

Academic project prototype, Business Marketing (M3) Group 4, TAPMI Bengaluru. Programme designs, fees and schedules are student proposals for evaluation only; not an approved TAPMI offering.

2. The buying centre

Sponsorship decisions are rarely made by one person. This specification is written for each seat at the table:

ROLE	WHAT THEY NEED FROM THIS DOCUMENT
CHRO / VP Talent	Succession-bench logic, nomination rubric, retention framing and the three-year seat-bank framework (sections 3, 6, 7)
Business-unit head	The capstone mechanism: how a sponsored employee's project solves a live problem in their P&L (section 4)
L&D partner	Reporting cadence, consent rules, learner support and assessment structure (sections 4 and 5)
Procurement / finance	Fee schedule, volume bands, escalation caps, invoicing route and tender floor rules (sections 6 and 7)

The trigger for the spend is usually a succession event: a critical role opens up, an external senior hire fails or proves expensive, or a high-potential manager signals flight risk. The sponsor buys a stronger succession bench and a retained employee, not a seat in a classroom.

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ACADEMIC CORE

3. The shared learning journey

Sponsored learners complete the same six-step academic journey as the individual Executive MBA. The sponsor sees it as five checkpoints, from nomination to capstone review.

1. **Nomination & sponsor briefing**

   Candidate selection against agreed criteria, an initial sponsor alignment call, and baseline capability scoping. The capstone theme and the support the employee will receive are agreed here.

2. **Business foundations**

   Strategy and execution, finance for decision-making, marketing and customer value, operations and process improvement, and business analytics, taught through cases.

3. **Leading through people**

   Communication, delegation, feedback conversations and team leadership, applied to the learner's own team back at work.

4. **Cross-functional decisions**

   Negotiation, enterprise resource allocation, stakeholder influence and ethical governance, rehearsed in simulations with peers from other functions and employers.

5. **Workplace capstone & sponsor review**

   A live organisational problem: diagnosis, intervention plan, implementation roadmap and success measures, presented to faculty and, if agreed, the sponsor.

Assessment combines module assignments, case analysis, peer-learning contribution and the capstone presentation. Completion requirements and award conditions are set by the institution and apply identically to sponsored and self-funded learners.

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SPONSOR LAYER

4. Sponsorship framework: nomination to capstone

4.1 The four-stage corporate nomination rubric

STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS	OUTPUT
1. Criteria setting	Sponsor and programme team agree nomination criteria: performance trajectory, scope of current role, readiness signals and a live business problem the learner could work on.	Written nomination criteria for the cohort
2. Sponsor alignment call	A structured conversation per nominee covering motivation, manager support, protected study time and capstone fit.	Confirmed nominee list with manager sign-off
3. Baseline capability scoping	Each nominee completes a baseline self-assessment (the companion P&L fluency diagnostic is one input), reviewed with the programme team.	Individual development baseline
4. Confirmation & briefing	Admission decisions rest with the institution. Confirmed learners and their managers receive a term-one briefing on schedule, expectations and reporting.	Enrolled cohort; briefing complete

4.2 Capstone governance and ROI milestones

The capstone is where sponsorship becomes measurable. It is governed at three points:

- **Problem value statement (start).** Learner and sponsor define the problem, why it matters commercially, and what a good outcome looks like. Confidentiality terms are agreed before work begins.
- **Midpoint review.** Faculty and learner check diagnosis quality and feasibility. The sponsor receives a one-line status, subject to learner consent.
- **Final defence with success measures.** The learner presents analysis, recommendation, implementation roadmap and measures to a faculty panel; a sponsor representative attends if the learner agrees. The success measures become the input for post-programme impact tracking.

4.3 Reporting and consent

Sponsors receive agreed milestone and attendance summaries at each term end. Reporting is subject to explicit learner consent and corporate confidentiality safeguards. Academic grades and assessment detail are never shared with the sponsor; academic standards and grading remain the sole prerogative of the institution, and employment terms remain an internal employer-employee matter.

COMMERCIALS

5. Fee schedule (planning figures)

Academic fee Rs 6,50,000 per seat over the programme, payable by term, plus applicable GST. The Sponsor Success Pack is Rs 40,000 per seat and is not discounted: it funds the sponsor relationship liaison, manager briefings, term-end progress notes and capstone alignment. Volume discounts apply to the academic fee only.

COHORT NOMINATION TIER	ACADEMIC FEE DISCOUNT	ACADEMIC FEE PER SEAT	SPONSOR SUCCESS PACK	TOTAL PER SEAT (BEFORE GST)
1-2 seats (single / pair)	0%	Rs 6,50,000	Rs 40,000	Rs 6,90,000
3-4 seats (small team)	5%	Rs 6,17,500	Rs 40,000	Rs 6,57,500
5-9 seats (talent cohort)	**8%**	**Rs 5,98,000**	**Rs 40,000**	**Rs 6,38,000**
10+ seats (enterprise bench)	12% (cap)	Rs 5,72,000	Rs 40,000	Rs 6,12,000

Worked example: a sponsor nominating 5 managers pays 5 x Rs 6,38,000 = Rs 31,90,000 before GST, against 5 x Rs 6,90,000 = Rs 34,50,000 at the undiscounted rate, a saving of Rs 2,60,000 across the programme.

Why these thresholds

Discounts begin at three seats because a sponsor nominating three or more employees is building a bench, and relationship costs spread across seats. The 12% cap sits at ten seats: beyond that, the need is a customised company cohort, better served by a tailored management development programme or a tender. The self-funded founding-cohort concession does not apply to sponsored seats, and volume discounts do not stack with it.

LONG-TERM TERMS

6. Three-year seat-bank framework

Organisations planning multi-year leadership pipelines may agree a three-year nomination framework:

- Agreed annual nominations, giving the sponsor reserved capacity and the programme planning visibility
- Annual fee escalation capped at 5% after year one
- Unused seats roll over for one subsequent cohort
- Precise terms require bilateral agreement; this framework is a proposal, not a standing offer

Tender and empanelment rules

For procurement-led processes: the floor is set at fully loaded cost per seat plus a minimum contribution. Payment schedule, reporting format and nomination windows are negotiable. Admission standards, academic assessment and the 12% discount cap are not.

> **WHAT THE SPONSOR IS REALLY BUYING**
>
> Compare the per-seat total with the cost of one failed external senior hire or one unfilled succession. The fee buys a retained, broadened leader plus a capstone that works a problem you already own. The companion framework, Measuring the Impact of Sponsored Executive Education, shows how to track that return honestly.

QUESTIONS

7. FAQs

Is this a different academic programme from the individual Executive MBA?

No. It shares the same academic core, faculty rigour and standards. The distinction is the enterprise sponsor layer connecting development to an organisational challenge.

Can employees continue working while enrolled?

Yes. The part-time blended format supports career continuity, combining scheduled live sessions with digital support so participants maintain ongoing business delivery. Protected study time is agreed with the manager at nomination.

What progress details does the sponsor receive?

Agreed attendance and milestone reporting at term end, subject to learner consent and confidentiality safeguards. Grades and assessment detail are never shared.

What is the programme duration and calendar?

Deliberately not fixed at proposal stage. Duration follows from curriculum breadth, workload, faculty availability and contact hours, and is set after institutional feasibility review. Indicative scheduling is discussed during nomination.

Is enrolment currently open?

No. This is an academic design proposal developed for course evaluation. It is not an official admissions service and applications are not being accepted.

> **STATUS OF THIS DOCUMENT**
>
> Prepared by a student project team for academic evaluation in the Business Marketing course at TAPMI Bengaluru. Programme designs, fees and services described here are proposals, not approved TAPMI offerings, and no enrolment or payment is being accepted.